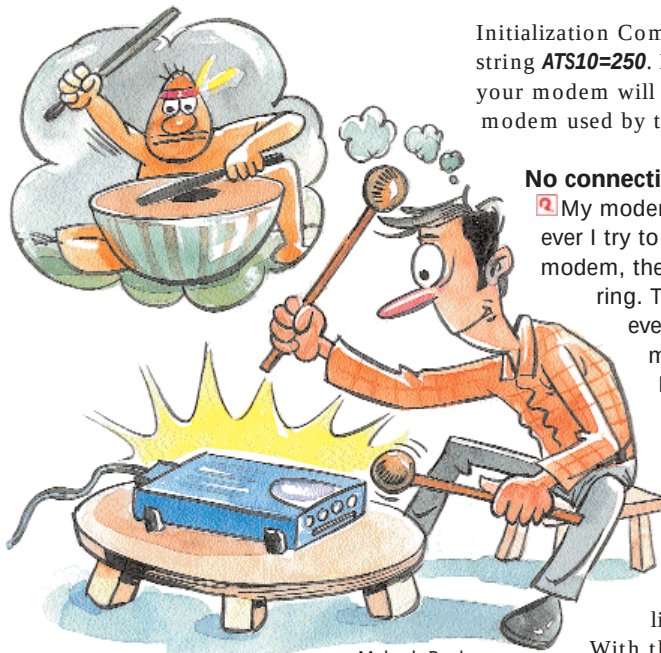




ILLUSTRATIONS: Mahesh Benkar

Initialization Command. Type in the string **ATS10=250**. If this changes to 255, your modem will never hang even if the modem used by the ISP hangs.

No connection between modems

Q My modem works fine but whenever I try to connect to another modem, the only thing it does is ring. The problem persists even after trying many terminal programs. However, my friend who uses the same model does not face any problem. Why is this so?

A In this case the error most probably lies in the S0 register.

With this register, you define the number of rings before the modem can react. However, if one adds '0' in this register then the modem does not record the connection.

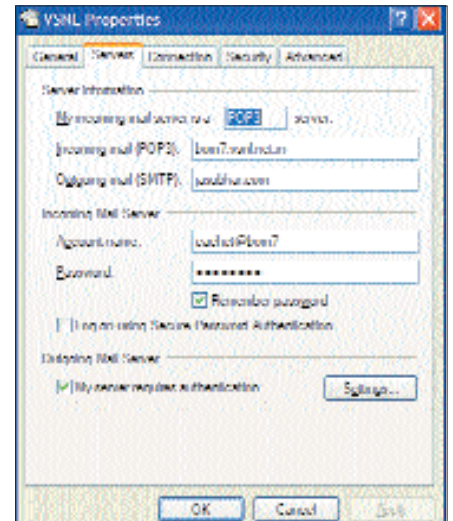
Go to **Start > Settings > Control Panel > System > Device Manager**, right-click on Modem and click on Properties. Here click on the Advanced tab and in the empty field under Extra Initialization Command, type in the string **ATS0=6**. If there is any other string already there such as **ATS10=250** just continue by adding the above string without any space. This specifies that the call should be received after six rings.

Downloading Web mail to the e-mail client

Q How do I configure my e-mail client to download my mail?

A Your ISP must have provided you the incoming and outgoing server names used to receive and send e-mail. If your ISP is VSNL, for example, then configure the e-mail client as POP3. To do so, in Outlook Express go to **Tools > Accounts**. There you should add mail, the necessary details, and when you are prompted for the server name, select POP3 and type **pop.vsnl.com** or **bom7.vsnl.net.in** (depending on the server name allocated to you) for the incoming and **smtp.vsnl.com** for the outgoing server.

If you want to download mail from Yahoo!, the incoming server should be put in as **pop.mail.yahoo.com** and the outgoing server should be set as **smtp.mail.yahoo.com**. If you have an account with Hotmail, fol-



Using your e-mail client to download mails will require the POP3 settings of your ISP

low the same procedure for adding an account. Outlook Express will automatically configure the same as an http account and also allow you to download mail from hotmail.

Connecting to another PC through a modem

Q I use Windows 98. How can I connect via a modem to another person's computer (without connecting to the Internet) and share my files?

A You will have to install Dialup Server Utility on one of the machines. You will have to configure this by setting the default server type as **PPP: Internet, Windows NT Server, Windows 98**. If you want you can assign a password. Install the TCP/IP on both the machines and assign a static IP address to Dial-up adapters.

To share files you will have to install 'File and Print Sharing for Microsoft Networks' on both machines. All these components can be installed and configured from **Start > Settings > Control Panel > Network**.

Once this is set up, you will have to create a dial-up connection from your machine. In the TCP/IP settings put the IP address of the server you are connecting from. If access password is assigned, enable Require Encrypted Password. You can provide a password in the Connection dialog box itself or you will be prompted for it once you are connected. To be able to browse the remote machine from Windows Explorer, click on 'Map network drive' from the Tools Menu. In the path

Low download speeds

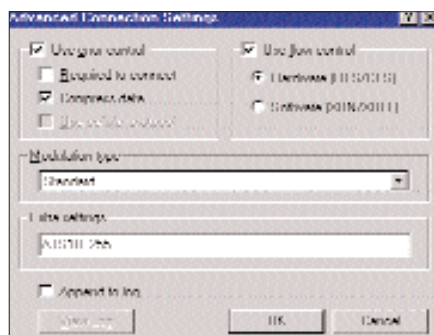
Q I use 56 Kbps modem yet I get only 2-3 Kbps download speed. Why?

A It seems the ISP you have subscribed to offers less bandwidth and yet allows more people to log on. As a result, you get low download speeds. Try changing your ISP.

Connect-reconnect

Q My modem keeps dropping the line no matter which number I dial. What do I do to stay connected?

A The problem could be your telephone itself; get the line checked by a linesman. Putting aside this probability, you could try this setting: go to **Start > Settings > Control Panel > System > Device Manager**, right-click on Modem and click on Properties. Here click on the Advance tab and empty the field under Extra



Adding a simple string will fix your connection problems